

Ion Maidens

Nobody's looking for just plain old telephony from a cell phone any more; they've become a part of our work, and a part of our play....

Sanket Naik

When it comes to cell phones, the country is at a sweet spot right now—the place where demand and supply curves intersect, and maximum satisfaction is achieved.

With portable productivity becoming a necessity, we're seeing multimedia phones with PDA-like functions, and PDAs with superb cameras and great PMP capabilities; people want one device to do it all, and they're prepared to shell out the premium. Be it the Apple iPhone, Nokia N95 or Sony Ericsson W910i, every cell phone has something new on offer—something radically different that promises to change the way we use them today.

A year ago, cameras and music players were considered luxury features, and only cell phones above Rs 10,000 used to come with them. Today, even entry level models from most vendors have two megapixel cameras and a decent music player. Cell phones are being increasingly used for listening to music, watching videos, taking causal photographs, playing games, chatting on messengers, reading e-books—the possibilities are unlimited. They reflect our lifestyles, and new innovations are based around our senses—touch, movement—something natural.

In this comparison, we were in for some surprises; the first was the iPhone—something so radical it changed our perceptions of how a phone should be. Second was the Sony Ericsson W910i, another example where movements are used for changing music tracks. Third, the three phones with five megapixel cameras that are as good as digital cameras. Fourth was Motorola's RAZR V2—a style icon—and lastly, the svelte Blackberry Pearl 8120. Then there were some that amazed us—the sheer value for money that is the Nokia E51. Read on to see the best for you.